



*Pelias was the ruler of Iolcus, but he was
an anxious king. An oracle had warned him
that one of his relatives would one day
steal his throne.*

The prophetess had told him: “The man who will challenge you will arrive on your doorstep wearing only one sandal.” From that day, Pelias had been on high alert. Then Pelias’s nephew Jason returned after being away for a long time. On his way back to the palace, Jason had fallen crossing a river and lost one of his sandals in the fast-flowing water.

*When Pelias saw Jason, he was struck with fear.
He made a plan to get rid of Jason.*

“Dear nephew,” Pelias told Jason, “there is a sheep’s fleece made of pure gold that belongs to King Aeëtes of Colchis, and I want it. Will you go and fetch it for me?” Jason was an adventurer at heart, and he agreed at once to go. What Jason did not know was how dangerous a journey it would be. Pelias had chosen this mission specifically because he believed there was no chance Jason, or his men, would survive it.

Jason gathered an impressive crew, including the mighty Herakles, son of Zeus, and the famed musician Orpheus. Together, they set sail on a sturdy ship called the Argo and headed for Colchis.